

# 200 Year Old Success Formula

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## Executive Summary

A 33-year-old entrepreneur who grew up poor dismantles the influencer PDF-selling trend and presents a straightforward, iterative success formula: get a job, save money, validate a business idea, invest, and repeat if it fails.

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## The Problem: Buying PDFs from Rich Kids 0:00

- The core accusation: most people chasing success are buying PDFs sold by wealthy content creators
  - Chris calls this "your strategy to getting rich" — and finds it absurd
  - His concern is that people *want* to believe these creators are self-made geniuses
- The typical pattern he sees:
  - A content creator blows up and people recommend him — "This guy made 2 million off Bitcoin"
  - A few minutes of research reveals the creator has a trust fund or wealthy background
  - Despite this, people still buy the PDF
- His frustration is that basic due diligence ("literally 3 minutes of research") exposes what's really going on
- He frames this as a generational or cultural blind spot, not just individual naivety

## Chris's Background: Growing Up Poor 0:48

- Grew up in genuine poverty — his credibility comes from lived experience, not inherited wealth
- His father had only two good years in business and left when Chris was **14**
  - When his father died, the only inheritance was **£24,000**
  - He used that money to pay for the funeral — "it doesn't stretch too far"
- His mother worked **five jobs** to keep the family afloat
- The level of poverty: choosing between cereal with milk or cereal with water

- "I figured you could put water on cereal. So let's go without the milk."
- He frames this hardship as an early education in entrepreneurship and resourcefulness

## The 200-Year-Old Success Formula 1:34

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- "It's a simple simple system but everyone over complicates it"
- The formula, step by step:
  - **Step 1:** Get a 9-to-5 job — "because you have no other option"
    - Rich-kid influencers tell you NOT to get a job; Chris says ignore that advice
    - Prioritise jobs with commission or unlimited hours (e.g. factory work) to maximise earnings
  - **Step 2:** Save as much money as possible from that job
    - Save aggressively and consistently — "save up, save up, save up"
  - **Step 3:** Come up with a solid entrepreneurial idea — a business, project, or product
  - **Step 4:** Validate the idea before investing
    - Do the calculations
    - Do the research, gather data
    - Build MVP models
    - Interview people and run surveys
    - Confirm it actually checks out
  - **Step 5:** If it checks out, invest your saved money into it

## What Happens When It Fails 2:20

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- The honest reality: it probably won't work the first time
  - Example: you've saved **£40,000**, invest it, and it fails — you're broke again
  - His response: "I'm sorry. You have to go back and get a job again and save up again."
- The system is explicitly iterative — not a one-shot opportunity
  - Go again, and again, and again
  - "You're just throwing enough s\*\*\* at the wall to see what sticks"
- The breakthrough comes when *something finally sticks* — then you go all in

"When something sticks, you finally make a breakthrough and then you go for it."

- This loop (work → save → invest → fail → repeat) is framed as the *only* realistic path for people without inherited wealth

## A Warning About Sitting on Savings 2:42

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- Many people with savings treat that money as a permanent safety net — Chris says it isn't
- His rough benchmarks for how long savings actually last as living expenses:

| Savings  | Approximate runway       |
|----------|--------------------------|
| £50,000  | ~2 years of wages        |
| £100,000 | ~4 years of wages (tops) |

- His point: savings erode fast; they must be deployed into a working idea, not hoarded
- The implication is urgency — sitting still is not a neutral position